

2 Sources of wisdom and authority	2.1	Emergence of Hindu traditions a) The Indus Valley culture, archaeological surveys; decline, Aryan invasion/migration/continuous development; significance for later Hinduism. b) Role of sacrifices and Agni, worship of Indra and role of soma. c) Points for discussion: significant problems with evidence and its interpretation; significance of possible links with the development of Hinduism; implications given that the evidence is not conclusive about the origins of Hinduism.
	2.2	Sources of wisdom and authority a) Shruti compared to smriti; meanings and examples, significance of their differences concerning authority; links with worship ceremonies. b) Vedas as the books of knowledge, including the Upanishads and the beginnings of philosophical traditions and their significance for the Vedanta schools. c) Smriti texts, including Ramayana and Mahabharata with accounts of avatars and the Puranas presenting ethical teachings; the significance of the use of narrative form in smriti.
	2.3	Points for discussion a) Implications arising from the breadth and range of scriptures for an understanding of Hinduism. b) Relative authority of some scriptures compared to the timeless knowledge of shruti scriptures. With reference to the ideas of J Brockington and W O'Flaherty.